

CEMS Application Form – Motivation Letter

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Last Name: Taube

First Name: David

Please write a one-page (not longer!) motivation letter that clearly conveys why you want to join the CEMS programme and what drives you personally and academically. Please don't just repeat your CV.

Focus especially on:

1. **Your motivation for applying to CEMS:**
What excites you about the programme? Which values, experiences, or goals connect with what CEMS offers?
2. **Key learning moments from your life:**
Choose one or two meaningful experiences – academic, professional, or personal – that shaped your ambitions, worldview, or approach to leadership. Explain what you learned and how these lessons prepare you for CEMS.
3. **Your study plan and international aspirations:**
Outline how you envision your study path within the programme and, if relevant, where you would ideally like to spend your CEMS term abroad—and why.

Aim for authenticity over formality. Show us what motivates you, what you hope to contribute to the CEMS community, and how the programme fits into your long-term goals.

CEMS Application Form – Motivation Letter**YOUR MOTIVATION LETTER**

Dear Sir or Madam,

The CEMS Master's in International Management appeals to me because it combines academic rigor with genuine international exposure and close interaction with global companies. I am looking for a programme that goes beyond theoretical knowledge and places students in multicultural, practice-oriented environments. The strong focus on global strategy, leadership across cultures, and the integration of projects makes CEMS particularly attractive to me.

Currently, I work full-time at SAP in the Corporate Strategy (Portfolio) team. In this role, I contribute to structured analyses and support planning and steering processes at Executive Board level. Being involved in strategic discussions within a multinational technology company has shown me how complex global decision-making truly is. It requires analytical depth, financial understanding, but also clarity in communication and the ability to translate data into actionable recommendations. This experience strengthened my ambition to work in international strategy or consulting, where structured thinking and global awareness are essential.

An experience that shaped my mindset early on was founding the start-up "BeeSafe" shortly after finishing school. The company developed environmentally friendly wasp repellents and gained nationwide media attention, including coverage on German television (e.g., SWR). Building the product, managing financing topics, and serving several thousand B2C customers required persistence and ownership. After completing my studies, I handed the company over to my co-founder in order to focus on my full-time role. This experience taught me how to make decisions under uncertainty and take responsibility for outcomes.

Living and working in Switzerland for a year during my studies further influenced my perspective. Coaching tennis alongside my academic commitments meant adapting to a new professional environment and communicating with people from different cultural backgrounds. It strengthened my independence and reinforced my motivation to work in international contexts. While I have not yet completed a formal semester abroad, I have deliberately sought international exposure and experiences that challenged me beyond familiar surroundings.

Within the CEMS programme, I am particularly interested in the modules on Global Strategy and Global Leadership, as well as the CEMS Business Project. Working in diverse teams on real corporate challenges reflects the environment in which I want to develop further. For my term abroad, I would ideally choose ESSEC Business School in Paris. During my school years, I spent time in France and developed an early interest in the language and culture. Studying at ESSEC would allow me to strengthen my French skills and gain deeper insight into a dynamic European business environment.

In the long term, I aim to pursue a career in international strategy consulting or corporate strategy within a multinational organization. CEMS represents an opportunity to deepen my analytical capabilities while further developing cultural awareness and responsible leadership. I am motivated not only to benefit from the programme, but also to contribute through my professional experience, entrepreneurial background, and genuine interest in international collaboration.